Ishkhan Khchoian

Project Manager — LegalTech & immigration platforms

Yerevan, Armenia · remote, or on-site / hybrid in Yerevan · open to relocation worldwide
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Armenian (native, C2) · English (C1) · Russian (C2)

PROFILE

For six years I was the person your product is built for. As a paralegal and then Senior Case Manager in U.S. immigration law I lived inside case pipelines, intake forms, evidence checklists and filing deadlines — owning the firm's most complex filings end to end, up to 12 at once, with 8 paralegals reporting to me on their own caseloads.

I am now a project manager, with U.S.-standards PM training, a month of C at 42 Yerevan and 2nd place at HackNation behind me. For a legaltech or immigration platform the combination is the point: I can speak to your legal customers in their own vocabulary because I have been on their side of the screen, and translate what they say into tickets, acceptance criteria and a realistic schedule. Domain knowledge like this usually takes a new PM a year to absorb.

One interview is enough — give me 30 minutes and a real problem from your team, and you'll see how I work.

WHY ME FOR THIS ROLE

- **I am the end user.** Six years inside immigration and civil practice — O-1B, EB-3, E-2 filings, intake, evidence, submission. I know which part of the workflow practitioners actually hate, and it is rarely the part software vendors fix first.
- **Discovery without a glossary.** Several hundred structured client intake interviews. Interviewing a paralegal or an attorney about their workflow is a conversation I can hold at full speed.
- **Legal operations, redesigned.** I rewrote the workflows, templates and checklists at M&M and they became the team standard; at Shamayev I built the Paralegal Academy, whose materials served 50+ people. That is exactly the problem legaltech sells against.
- **Requirements and acceptance criteria.** I reviewed eight specialists' output against written standards weekly — and in law an ambiguous sentence loses, so written precision is a professional habit.
- **Compliance and contracts.** Law degree, civil-contract analysis, claims, and an arbitration court from the inside. Regulatory conversations do not need translating for me.
- **Delivery volume.** 200+ parallel cases and 30+ hearings a week; 12 complex projects at once; teams up to 20.

SKILLS

- **Delivery.** scope and milestone planning · Agile/Scrum · backlog grooming · risk and dependency tracking · Gantt charts · release coordination · reporting
- **Product & analysis.** user interviews and discovery · requirements, user stories and acceptance criteria · as-is / to-be process mapping · workflow redesign · SOPs, checklists and runbooks
- **Domain.** U.S. immigration filings (O-1B, EB-3, E-2) · case management pipelines · civil contracts and claims · arbitration procedure · legal training and onboarding
- **Tools.** Jira · Confluence · Notion · Trello · Monday · Bitrix24 · AmoCRM · Google Analytics · MS Office

EXPERIENCE

Freelance — legal & project work · PM training Feb 2026 – present

- Legal: IP assignment for works of popular musicians; corporate structure for a crypto trader; advised on opening a crypto-exchange office in Armenia.
- Projects: COO of the **SayWhen.am** startup (AI voice agents); business research for a water production line; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); sale of family real estate; designed a US client-acquisition pilot for **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy).

Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Ran up to **12 complex client projects in parallel** end to end — requirements, planning, execution and delivery against immovable external deadlines.
- Coordinated **8 specialists**, reviewed their output against defined acceptance criteria and acted as the escalation point.
- Rewrote the team's workflows, templates and checklists; they became the default way of working.

Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp. Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Delivered live events for audiences of **100 to 3,000** — several in parallel, on dates that could not slip.
- Owned vendors, logistics, scheduling and day-of operations.

Project Manager — Qanon Construction Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, scope agreement, timelines and internal follow-through across daily operations.

Senior Paralegal — Shamayev Business Law Corp. · Paralegal — Bloomrich Law Firm Feb 2023 – Aug 2024

- Built and taught the **Paralegal Academy**, an internal training programme; the materials went on to serve **50+ people**.
- Carried key accounts with full autonomy and deputised for the team lead.

Judge's Associate — Arbitration Court of the Magadan Region Nov 2021 – Dec 2022

- **200+ parallel cases, 30+ hearings a week**, covering three roles at once — sustained parallel workload without dropping state.
- Drafted judicial acts, managed case materials and kept document flow moving.

Assistant Lawyer — Bar Association Dec 2019 – Aug 2021

- Civil-contract analysis and claims; legal support to a trade and construction organisation.

Administrator / Project Manager — LLC "SIS" (construction & retail group) Jun 2015 – Sep 2019

- **15+ construction and retail projects**, at times three sites at once, with teams of 2–20; contractors, procurement, transport, tenders and recruitment.
- Built the first schedules and Gantt charts used across the projects.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

- **Project management, U.S. standards** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success" — Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; 21 Jul – 21 Aug 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement.
- **Project Management** — PM Club, 2023 (52 academic hours).
- **Piscine intensive (C programming)** — 42 Yerevan, Nov–Dec 2025; passed selection, alongside a full-time job.
- **Bachelor of Law, with honours** — North-Eastern State University, 2021.
- **Civil Law, Faculty of Law** — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.

ALSO

- **2nd place, HackNation** local pitches, final at TUMO Labs (July 2026); **Startup Seaside Summit** — participant.
- **Highload++** (700 attendees) — organising team, led a crew of 12; performance bonus.
- **Ethos Foundation** — HQ coordinator, Sep 2023 – Oct 2024; aid to ~100 families a day.